

NEVER AN ADEYEMI

EPISODE 7: THE MEMORIAL

PALMFIRE SEASON 1

Screenplay draft

Based on Mario's final story brief and story bible

Contemporary Lagos romance with stakes

FADE IN:

EXT. OBI FAMILY HOME - AFTERNOON

A tailor removes the last pin from Ify's navy dress. Mr. Obi waits by the open gate.

IFY

You should wear the black suit.

MR. OBI

I am driving.

IFY

Not today.

MR. OBI

Someone has to bring us home.

IFY

You are allowed to be at your own memorial.

MR. OBI

It is not mine.

IFY

They made you part of the story.

A message appears on Ify's phone from Tobi: I WILL BE THERE.

MR. OBI

He may need to stand somewhere.

IFY

He has a whole house.

MR. OBI

A house is not a place to stand when everyone is asking you to kneel.

CUT TO:

INT. EXECUTOR'S OFFICE - MORNING

Mrs. Eze reviews the formal offer with Mr. Obi and Ify before the memorial.

MRS. EZE

The codicil requires a decision free of pressure.

IFY

The family brought a waiver.

MRS. EZE

Record the approach. Do not let it replace the formal process.

MR. OBI

They will say I came for money.

MRS. EZE

They may say whatever helps them stand upright.

IFY

Then we stand upright too.

Mr. Obi places his hand over hers. Tobi waits outside the glass door, unheard.

CUT TO:

EXT. MEMORIAL VENUE - AFTERNOON

Cars arrive under white umbrellas. The Adeyemi name is printed on every programme. Mr. Obi parks away from the entrance.

MR. OBI

You do not have to go inside.

IFY

They invited the city to watch us arrive.

MR. OBI

Let them watch.

Tobi approaches from the entrance.

TOBI

Ify.

IFY

I am not safe enough for you to use my name today.

TOBI

I heard about the waiver.

IFY

Your family thinks my father can be frightened into disappearing.

TOBI

I will not let them.

IFY

You are one person in a family that has already chosen.

Mr. Obi offers Ify his arm.

MR. OBI

We should go in.

IFY

Together.

She takes his arm. Tobi follows behind them.

CUT TO:

INT. MEMORIAL HALL - LATER

A choir finishes. Chief's portrait stands beneath a wreath. The family sits in front; Mr. Obi and Ify sit near the back.

FAMILY ELDER

Chief believed legacy was a responsibility
shared by those who remained.

Yewande rises with no notes.

YEWANDE

Grief can make a family generous. It can
also make a family vulnerable to people who
mistake access for entitlement.

Several guests turn toward Mr. Obi. Kunle keeps his eyes forward.

IFY

She is speaking about my father.

MR. OBI

Let her finish.

YEWANDE

A name, a photograph or a late claim cannot
replace the years it takes to build a
company.

Ify rises.

IFY

Neither can a polished speech replace the
years my father carried this family's work.

The room goes still. Tobi looks at Kunle, then at Ify.

CUT TO:

EXT. MEMORIAL VENUE - COURTYARD - EVENING

Guests gather in small, embarrassed circles. Ify and Mr. Obi move
toward the exit. Tobi catches up.

TOBI

You did not have to answer her.

IFY

Someone did.

TOBI

I was going to.

IFY

When?

Tobi looks toward the hall. Kunle stands beside Yewande, untouched by the scene.

TOBI

I was trying to find the right moment.

IFY

You should have given me courage, not a timetable.

TOBI

Ify-

IFY

Do not follow us through the side gate.

She walks away with her father. Tobi remains between the hall and the road, unable to choose either.

FADE OUT.